

Anyone who stops learning is old, whether at twenty or eighty.

—Henry Ford

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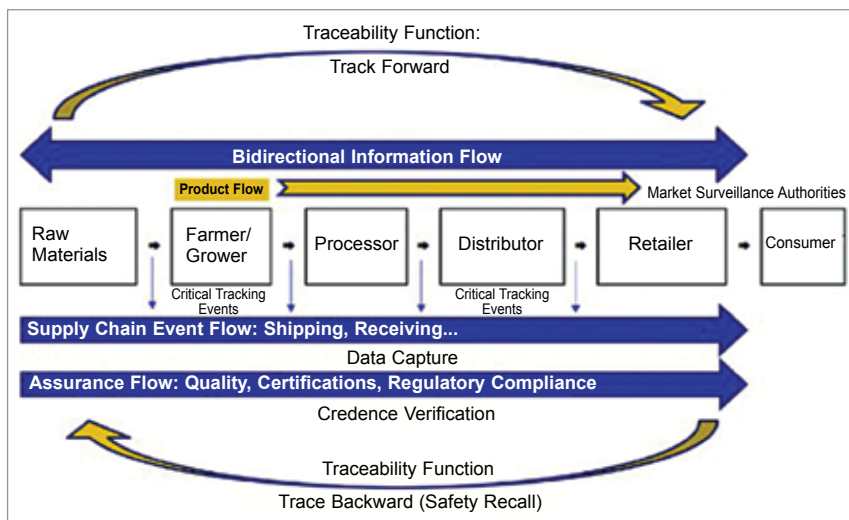


Fig. 3: Traceability in blockchain

food system—from producers, suppliers, manufacturers, distributors, and retailers—to make their supply chains less susceptible to fraud. The supply chain members can transparently trace food products in the supply chain upstream and downstream, shining a light on the authenticity of both raw ingredients and packaged goods. This enables the participants to securely upload, manage, and access transactional data, helping detect or mitigate fraudulent action along the supply chain. Additionally, this assists the certification agencies to share inspections, quality certifications, and registrations, enabling accountability for acquired data at each step.

In addition to Tyson Foods, Nestlé, Dole, Walmart, and Kroger, other companies in the collaboration include Driscoll's, Golden State Foods, McCormick and Co., McLane Co., and Unilever. They are working with IBM to identify new areas where the global food supply chain can benefit from blockchain.

"Unlike any technology before it, blockchain is transforming the way like-minded organisations come together and enabling a new level of trust based on a single view of the truth," says Marie Wieck, general manager of IBM Blockchain. This "single view of the truth" refers to the digital ledger of transactions that is available to all participating members, but which cannot be altered without leaving a record of who

changed what and when.

Bitcoin and other similar cryptocurrency applications use an open-source, peer-to-peer network of decentralised computers to process the complex blockchain algorithms and maintain system integrity. Corporate blockchain applications, on the other hand, including IBM's and those of large financial institutions, are 'closed' and use their own centralised computer systems and private networks.

Conclusion

Logistics and supply chain management is due for an overhaul. As globalisation increases the complexity of the food supply chain, blockchain and other innovative technologies can help retailers keep track of suppliers, minimise crises, and remain competitive. Consumers also stand to benefit from a safer, more transparent food supply chain. Gaining a more accurate source of information could attract conscious consumers and keep the industry honest. Retail giants are already implementing blockchain technology in their logistics and supply chain management strategies. Market trends will only continue to drive innovation in blockchain logistics. **EFY**

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